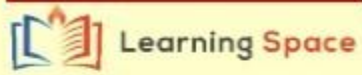


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NEWSPAPER

24th July, 2017

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

30th WEEK



CATALONIA & SPAIN

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... REGIONALISM.



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NEWSPAPER EDITORIALS

... DISCUSSION

24th JULY, 2017

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Spanish steps

Madrid pulls out all the stops ahead of the secession vote in Catalonia

Ahead of the controversial October 1 referendum on secession in Catalonia, the Spanish government's awkward move of tightening the purse-strings could prove politically costly. There is cause for concern that Prime Minister Mariano Rajoy's meddling with the financial priorities of Barcelona will play into the hands of the separatists. A veteran of many a crisis, Mr. Rajoy recently issued instructions to the regional government to ensure that not a single euro earmarked for development activities is diverted to the vote. The decision requiring weekly certification follows a judicial declaration that all expenditure towards the vote were unconstitutional. Recourse to such seemingly stringent measures has predictably drawn flak from Catalan leaders, who were already embittered that the province is being denied its due share of the overall tax revenues. Madrid's mainstream political parties are opposed to the long-standing demand of Catalonia for independent statehood. Riding on the overwhelming support in the national parliament, Mr. Rajoy's centre-right coalition is determined to block the proposed independence referendum. The government is even contemplating the invocation of Article 155 of the constitution to exercise direct authority over the north-eastern region in the event of a worst-case scenario. The country's constitutional court is widely expected to rule that any referendum, as well as secession from the union, is violative of the constitution.

But that is where legalese ends and politics inevitably takes over. After holding several symbolic independence votes across many municipalities over the past decade, Catalan nationalists sense that what once seemed a distant dream could one day be turned into reality. The economic and social upheaval following the bursting of the Spanish housing bubble after the 2007-8 financial crisis, local problems were deflected on to the national stage. The 2015 election of the regional government, with a known pro-independence bent, might have been a reflection of this shift in perception. A perception among Catalan youth that the national government is clamping down on democratic expression

THE  HINDU

Date : 24th July, 2017

*North
Atlantic
Ocean*

PORTUGAL

SPAIN

Catalonia
region

Balearic Sea

Alboran Sea



UNITED KINGDOM

*North
Atlantic
Ocean*

North Sea



NORTHERN
IRELAND

IRELAND

WALES

England

NETHERLANDS

BELGIUM

GERMANY





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INDIA

NEPAL

BANGLADESH

Myanmar
(Burma)

VIETNAM

Lao PDR

Rakhine

THAILAND

CAMBODIA

Bay of Bengal

Gulf





SERBIA

Bosnia and Herzegovina

MONTENEGRO

KOSOVO

MACEDONIA (FYROM)

ALBANIA

BULGARIA

Black Sea

GEORGIA

ARMENIA

AZERBAIDZHAN

TURKEY

Aegean Sea

Greece

Ionian Sea

SYRIA

IRAQ

CYPRUS

Lebanon

Mediterranean Sea

NEWS REPORT



Mariano Rajoy Brey
President, Spain

- A referendum on secession in Catalonia is going to take place on October 1.
- The Spanish government tightened the purse-strings before the referendum.
- The Government has recently issued instructions to the regional Government to ensure that not a single euro earmarked for development activities is diverted to the vote.
- The Government is even contemplating the invocation of Article 155 of the Constitution to exercise direct authority over the north-eastern region.

Spanish steps

Madrid pulls out all the stops ahead of the secession vote in Catalonia

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WHAT IS ALL ABOUT THIS CATALONIA?

- It is proud of its own identity and language.
- It is one of Spain's richest and most highly industrialised regions, and people are generally independent-minded.
- Barcelona is the important city.
- Catalonia's beaches attract tourists almost from across Europe.
- When Spain became a republic in 1931, Catalonia was soon given broad autonomy, but due to the subsequent developments, Catalan nationalism was repressed and the use of the Catalan language was restricted.
- There is also a feeling that affluent region pays more to Madrid than it gets back.

WE EXPRESS OUR SINCERE THANKS FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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